
Bitcoin P2P e-cash paper
Bitcoin:
A Peer-to-Peer
Electronic Cash System
Satoshi Nakamoto
31 OCT 2008
b-money
Hashcash

THE WHITEPAPER

005 / 31 OCT 2008 / SATOSHI NAKAMOTO / MYTHIC

NO TRUSTED THIRD PARTY.

Nine sheets rise over a sleeping town. Lines of light pass from roof to roof, as though an idea has begun to travel before anyone knows where it will lead. The town is imagined, with Japanese-inspired streets as a nod to the name Satoshi Nakamoto. It is not a clue to the author's identity or location.

On 31 October 2008, someone writing as Satoshi Nakamoto sent the Cryptography Mailing List a message headed Bitcoin P2P e-cash paper. It introduced Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System and linked to the nine-page paper. The proposal tackled a difficult question: how could people send digital money directly to each other when a digital payment can be copied and spent twice?

The paper described a peer-to-peer network that records transactions in a chain of blocks. Participants use proof of work to agree on a public history, making old entries progressively harder to change. Instead of asking a trusted third party to decide which payment came first, the network could establish an order itself. This was a published proposal, not yet the launch of the Bitcoin network; the first block would come later.

The floating pages carry pieces of that story. On one is the mailing-list subject. On another are b-money and Hashcash, both named in the paper's references. Hashcash also reaches back to card 003. RPOW, the subject of card 004, is part of our wider timeline, but the Bitcoin whitepaper does not cite it. The glowing lines connect the pages to ordinary homes: an artistic picture of an idea entering public view, not a map of where it began.

HIDDEN IN THE ART

01 NINE PAGES

The hero sheet and eight smaller sheets echo the original paper's nine pages, including its references. The floating arrangement and most small text are illustrative, not a page-by-page facsimile.

02 THE ANNOUNCEMENT

Bitcoin P2P e-cash paper appears on the left sheet, matching the original mailing-list subject. The date stamp marks 31 October 2008, when Satoshi announced the paper.

03 EARLIER IDEAS

b-money and Hashcash appear together on a right-hand sheet. Both are cited in the whitepaper; Hashcash is also our card 003 callback. RPOW is deliberately absent because the paper does not name it.

04 A NETWORK, NOT AN ADDRESS

Light links the sheets and rooftops, echoing a peer-to-peer network. The Japanese-inspired town is fictional and does not assert that Satoshi lived there or that Bitcoin was founded in Japan.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Satoshi Nakamoto, Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System, 2008; Bitcoin P2P e-cash paper, Cryptography Mailing List, 31 October 2008. The paper has nine pages and cites Wei Dai's b-money and Adam Back's Hashcash; it does not mention RPOW. The city, floating sheets, date stamp, light trails and most printed linework are visual interpretations. Satoshi's real identity and location are not established by this scene.